

Aithent Code of Business Conduct and Ethics

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Document Revision History

This section describes the details of changes that have resulted in the document.

Serial No.	Version Number	Date	Sections Affected	Changes in Brief / Remarks
1	1.0	24-06-2019	-----	Initial version
2	2.0	01-07-2020		Reviewed with no changes
3	3.0	01-07-2021		Reviewed with no changes
4	4.0	01-07-2022		Reviewed with no changes
5	5.0	25-03-2023		Reviewed with no changes to main content. Changes made to format, grammar

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1. OBJECTIVE

i. The Code of Conduct is an articulation of the values and principles that govern the way the Aithent Group of companies and their employees conduct themselves.

ii. The Code addresses both corporate and individual conduct and can particularly serve as a guide whenever ethical dilemmas present themselves before any employee.

iii. The trust reposed in the Company by our stakeholders is in many ways a unique asset in the Indian corporate world. The formalization of a Code of Conduct is a testament to the value we attach to this asset.

2. ROLE OF COMPANY LEADERSHIP

i. To make compliance with the Code a vital part of business activities.

ii. To establish and maintain the Company's conduct of business in accordance with the Code.

iii. To appoint an Ethics officer to monitor compliance with the Code of Business Conduct & Ethics.

iv. Create a culture that promotes compliance, encourages employees to raise their questions and concerns, provides counseling, and prohibits retribution.

v. To actively assist employees in all aspects related to understanding and complying with the code.

vi. To widely communicate all aspects of the Code and its management to all employees.

vii. To set up a formal, retribution–free mechanism for addressing employee concerns and take prompt remedial action where required.

3. ROLE OF EMPLOYEES

i. Ensure personal and organizational compliance with the Code.

ii. Seek assistance from managers and other company resources about the application of the code.

iii. Promptly report:
- Any concerns about possible violations of the Code.
- Any concerns about likely possible violations of the Code.
- Any concerns about a possible request to violate the Code.

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iv. Ensure that no retribution is taken against anyone for reporting or supplying information about a concern.

4. CODES OF CONDUCT

i. National Interest

Aithent shall be committed in supporting the functioning of the constitution and the electoral system of the country in which it operates with utmost transparency and fairness. Aithent shall ethically participate in the economic development of such countries in which it operates or does business with and shall not engage in any activity that would adversely affect such objective.

Aithent shall conduct its business affairs in accordance with the applicable economic, policies, objectives and priorities of the Nation's government and shall strive to make a positive contribution to the achievement of such goals at the international, national, and regional level as appropriate.

ii. Financial & Statutory Regulations

Aithent shall prepare and maintain its accounts fairly and accurately in accordance with the accounting and financial reporting standards and comply fully with all applicable laws and regulations, which represent the generally accepted guidelines, principles, standards, laws and regulations of the country in which the company conducts its business affairs.

The Company cannot accept practices which are unlawful or may be damaging to its reputation. In the event the implication of any law is not clear, the Company's Legal Department shall be consulted for advice.

It shall be necessary for employees to voluntarily ensure that areas of operation / business are open to audit and the conduct of activities is totally auditable. All required information shall be accessible to company auditors and other authorized parties and government agencies. Any willful material misrepresentation of and/or misinformation on the financial accounts and reports shall be regarded as a violation of the Code apart from inviting appropriate civil or criminal action under the relevant laws.

iii. Fair Trade Practices

Aithent shall fully strive for the establishment and support of a competitive open market economy in India and abroad.

Specifically, Aithent shall not engage in activities which generate or support the formation of monopolies, dominant market positions, cartels, and similar unfair trade practices.

Aithent shall market its products and services on its own merits and shall not make unfair and misleading statements about competitors' products and services. Any collection of

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competitive information shall be made only in the normal course of business and shall be obtained only through legally permitted sources and means.

iv. Equal Opportunities Employer

Aithent is committed to providing equal opportunities by providing gender friendly workplace to all its employees and all qualified applicants for employment without regard to their race, caste, religion, color, ancestry, marital status, sex, age, nationality, disability, and veteran status.

Aithent demands, demonstrates, and promotes professional behavior and respectful treatment of all employees and seeks to enhance equal opportunities for men and women, by prevention /stopping /redressal of harassment whether sexual, physical, verbal, or psychological at the workplace and by institution of good employment practices.

v. Anti-Corruption & Anti-Bribery

Bribery/Corruption is defined as receiving or offering of an undue reward from/to any third party. Aithent follows a zero-tolerance approach towards bribery & corruption.

Aithent is committed to the prevention, deterrence and detection of fraud, bribery, and other corrupt business practices. It is Aithent's policy to conduct all its business activities with honesty, integrity and the highest possible ethical standards and vigorously enforce its business practice of not engaging in bribery in corruption, across the globe.

Aithent prohibits the receipt of gifts and gratuities, particularly from customers, suppliers, vendors, and consultants with which the Company has business dealings. Aithent and its employees shall not offer or make, directly or indirectly, any illegal payments, remuneration, gifts, donations, funds, or comparable benefits which are intended to or perceived to obtain business or uncompetitive favors for the conduct of its business to any firm, person, or government agency.

The only exception is the receipt of complementary items that carry the Company's name printed or embossed on it to clearly establish that it is a sale promotional or related to employee events. To the extent possible, all gifts or hospitalities must be declined, however, employees may offer nominal gifts (not exceeding $ 20) which are customarily given and are of commemorative nature for special events intended to improve the image of Aithent.

vi. Whistle Blower

Every member of Aithent shall promptly report to the ethics officer any actual or possible violation of the code or an event the member becomes aware of that could affect the business or reputation of Aithent.
Any person who has reliable information about a violation of the Code and reports a concern is a whistle blower.

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They are not required or expected to act as investigators or finders of facts, nor would they determine the appropriate corrective or remedial action that may be warranted in each case. All employees are eligible to make protected disclosures under this Code. The whistle blower can choose to be anonymous in case they desire.

Protected disclosures should preferably be emailed or be reported in writing in English, Hindi or in the regional language of the place of employment of the whistle blower. Protected disclosures should be factual and not speculative or in conclusion should contain as much specific information as possible.

All protected disclosures will be thoroughly investigated by the Ethics officer, the procedure for which is outlined in Appendix 1. This may entail the formation of a panel for investigating the concerns reported. The identity of the subject and Whistle blower will be kept confidential to the extent possible given the legitimate needs of law and investigation.

Subjects will be informed of the allegations at the outset of a formal investigation and have opportunities for providing their input during the investigation. Subjects have a responsibility not to interfere with the investigation. Evidence shall not be withheld, destroyed, or tampered with, and witnesses shall not be influenced, threatened, or intimidated by the Subjects.

Subjects shall be informed of the outcome of the investigation. The investigation shall be completed within 45 days of the receipt of the protected disclosure.
No unfair treatment shall be meted out to whistleblower by virtue of having reported a protected Disclosure.
Complete protection will be given to whistle blower against any unfair practice like retaliation, threat of termination/suspension of service, disciplinary action, transfer, refusal of promotion etc. The identity of whistle blower shall be kept confidential to the extent possible and permitted under law.

If an investigation leads the panel to conclude that an improper or unethical act has been committed, the panel shall make a recommendation for appropriate disciplinary action which shall be vetted & finalized by the Apex committee comprising of Executive Management & the Ethics officer.

vii. Political Non-Alignment

Aithent shall not support directly or indirectly, financially, or otherwise any specific political party or campaign or candidate for political office in any manner whatsoever to derive any advantage.

viii. Health, Safety and Environment

The Company attaches great importance to a healthy and safe work environment. Aithent is committed to providing good physical working conditions and encourages high standards of hygiene and housekeeping. Particular attention should be paid to training of employees to increase safety awareness and adoption of safe working methods, particularly designed

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to prevent serious or fatal accidents. Aithent shall comply with all regulations regarding the preservation of the environment of the territory it operates in.

ix. Quality

Aithent shall be committed to provide best in class products and services backed by stringent quality measures and checks and consistent with the requirements of the customers to ensure their total satisfaction.
Every employee of Aithent shall ensure, always, the integrity of data or information furnished by him to the Company.

x. Cooperation of Group Companies

Aithent and its group companies shall co-operate with each other by sharing physical, human and management resources if this does not adversely affect its business interests and shareholder value.
In the procurement of resources, products, and services the Company shall give preference to another Group Company as long as it can provide these on competitive terms relative to third parties.

xi. Public / Third Party Representation

Aithent respects the information requirements of the public, its stakeholders, suppliers and third parties. In all its public appearance with respect to disclosing company and business information to public constituencies such as the media, the financial community, employees, and shareholders the Company or the Group shall be represented only by specifically authorized employees as prescribed in the communication guidelines of the company.

It will be the sole responsibility of these authorized representatives to disclose information on the Company. Third Parties which have business dealings with Aithent but are not members of the Group such as consultants, agents, contractors, suppliers, etc. shall not be authorized to represent the Company if their business conduct and ethics are known to be inconsistent with the Code or in absence of any written prior permission.

xii. Use of Aithent Brand

The usage of the Company Name and trade/service mark shall be governed by manuals, codes and agreements, to be issued by the Authorized Personnel. The use of the brand is defined in and regulated by the Authorized Personnel.

xiii. Company Policies and Guidelines

Aithent shall recommend to its Board of Directors the adoption of policies and guidelines periodically formulated by the Company.

xiv. Shareholders

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Aithent shall be committed to enhancing shareholder value and comply with all regulations and laws that govern shareholders' rights. The Board of Directors of the Company shall duly and fairly inform its shareholders.
about all relevant aspects of the Company's business and disclose such information in accordance with the respective regulations and agreements.

xv. Ethical Conduct

Every employee of the Company, which shall include Whole-time Directors and the Managing Director, shall deal on behalf of the Company with professionalism, honesty, integrity as well as high moral and ethical standards. Such conduct shall be fair and transparent and be perceived to be as such by third parties.
Every employee shall be responsible for the implementation of and compliance with the Code in his professional environment. Failure to adhere to the Code could attract the most severe consequences including termination of employment.

xvi. Conflict of Interest

An employee of Aithent shall not engage in any business, relationship or activity which might detrimentally conflict with the interest of his Company or the Group. A conflict of interest, actual or potential, may arise where, directly or indirectly, (a) an employee of Aithent engages in a business, relationship or activity with anyone who is party to a transaction with his Company, (b) an employee is in a position to derive a personal benefit or a benefit to any of his relatives by making or influencing decisions relating to any transaction, and (c) an independent judgement of the Company's or Group's best interest cannot be exercised. The main areas of such actual or potential conflicts of interest would include the following:

1) Financial interest of an employee of Aithent or his relatives including the holding of an investment in the subscribed share capital of any company or a share in any firm which is an actual or potential competitor, supplier, customer, distributor, joint venture or other alliance partner of Aithent . (The ownership of up to 1% of the subscribed share capital of a publicly held company shall not ordinarily constitute a financial interest for this purpose.)
2) An employee of Aithent conducting business on behalf of his Company or being able to influence a decision regarding his Company's business with a supplier or customer of which his relative is a principal, officer or representative, resulting in a benefit to him or his relative.
   Award of benefits such as increase in salary or other remuneration, posting, promotion or recruitment of a relative of an employee of Aithent where such an individual can influence the decision regarding such benefits.
3) Acceptance of donations, hospitality and/or entertainment beyond the customary level from existing or potential suppliers, customers or other third parties which have business dealings with the Company.

Notwithstanding that such or other instances of conflict of interest exist due to any historical reasons, adequate and full disclosure by the interested employees should be made to the company's management. It is also incumbent upon every employee to make a full disclosure of any interest which the employee or the employee's immediate family,

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which would include parents, siblings, spouse, and children, may have in a company or firm which is a supplier, customer, distributor of or has other business dealings with his Company.

xvii. Protecting Company Assets

The assets of the Company should not be misused, or misrepresented, but employed for the purpose of conducting the business for which they are duly authorized. These include tangible assets such as equipment and machinery, systems, facilities, materials, resources as well as intangible assets such as proprietary information, relationships with customers and suppliers, etc. Company assets should be used in accordance with the information security guidelines and principles of the Data protection Act, adopted by Aithent.

xviii. Reporting Concerns

Every employee of Aithent shall promptly report to the management / and or the Ethics Officer, any actual or possible violation of the Code or an event he/she becomes aware of that could affect the business or reputation of his or any other Group Company.
A concern can be reported in the following three ways:

1) Email a concern to myvoice@Aithent.com.
2) Write down the concern and submit to OPM / Senior Leader

5. Contact

For any clarification, please contact the Head of OPM.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF RECEIPT OF AITHENT CODE OF BUSINESS CONDUCT AND ETHICS

I have received and read the Company's Code of Conduct and Ethics. I understand the standards and policies contained in the Company Code of Business Conduct and Ethics and understand that there may be additional policies or laws specific to my job and/or the location of my posting. I further agree to follow the values of the Company in all that I do and comply with the Company Code of Conduct and Ethics.

Employee Name -

Employee No -

Signature -

Date -

Please sign and return this form to the Human Resources Department.

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